Unit 12 · should / shouldn't and could / couldn't

Name _____

THE BIG IDEA

Should gives advice. Could is the past of can. After both the verb stays plain.

Should — совет («стоит / не стоит»). Could — прошедшее от can («мог»). После них глагол без to и без -s.

How we build it

WHICH	PATTERN	EXAMPLE	РУССКИЙ
Advice	should / shouldn't + base verb	**You should drink some water.**	Тебе надо выпить воды.
Question	Should + subject + base verb?	**Should I take medicine? Yes, you should.**	Мне принять лекарство?
Ability then	could / couldn't + base verb	**I couldn't read when I was four.**	Я не умел читать в четыре.
Question (past)	Could + subject + base verb?	**Could you swim? Yes, I could.**	Ты умел плавать?
Same for all	I / he / they should	**He should go to bed.**	

When we use it

Give advice: You should stay in bed.
Дать совет.

Say what was impossible: I couldn't eat.
Сказать, что не мог.

Talk about being little: I could walk but I couldn't read.
Рассказать о детстве.

REMEMBER

good / bad idea, advice, 'What's the matter?' → should / shouldn't. when I was five / last year / many years ago + ability → could / couldn't.

RUSSIAN AND ENGLISH

Russian «тебе надо / следует» is one word. In English should never changes: I / he / they should. Never 'should to', never 'should goes'.

Watch out! We often say...

~~You should to drink water.~~	**You should drink water.**
~~He should goes to bed.~~	**He should go to bed.**
~~Yesterday I can't eat.~~	**Yesterday I couldn't eat.**
~~She could swam when she was four.~~	**She could swim when she was four.**

EASY TRICK

should = a good idea. could = can in the past (when I was five, last year). The verb after both is plain: should go, could swim.

Try it! Circle the right answer

1 He has a stomachache. He ___ eat chocolates. (should / shouldn't)

2 You ___ drink water. (should / should to)

3 When I was five, I ___ swim. (couldn't / can't)

4 ___ you read when you were four? (Can / Could)

5 She should ___ to bed. (go / goes)

6 Yesterday he ___ eat. (can't / couldn't)

Answers: 1 shouldn't · 2 should · 3 couldn't · 4 Could · 5 go · 6 couldn't